DCDC LLC + 4SBB G474 — Design Notes

Oct 17, 2026 · @Chotiwat Preamprasertsook

Summary

The converter is now isolated and has two stages. A fixed-ratio LLC (DCX, about 205 kHz) gives 3 kVrms basic isolation and an isolated bus roughly equal to VIN. The original 4SBB then regulates on the secondary side, still controlled by the STM32G474 HRTIM. Modelled efficiency at 50 W is 91.4-91.8% from 24-48 V in and 86.9% at 12 V in. Worst-case loss is 7.5 W, at 12 V in.

Parameter	Target	Design
Input	12-48 V DC	12-48 V, 51 V TVS, 7 A fuse (primary)
Output	1.5-48 V, 5 A, 50 W	CV/CC envelope: 5 A up to 10 V, 50 W above
Isolation	Basic, about 3 kVrms	PQ2620 transformer + CA-IS3642LVW isolator (5 kVrms)
Topology	LLC + regulator, cost premium at most 20%	LLC DCX 1:2:2 -> secondary 4SBB. Premium is about 55% (see BOM)
Controller	STM32G474RBT6	On the secondary. HRTIM C = LLC, D = SR, A/E = 4SBB
Cooling	Passive, 25-30 C	4.5-7.5 W total; hottest parts are the 4SBB FETs (up to 1.4 W)
Comms	Isolated CAN	CA-IS3062VW, 5 kVrms
Address	6-bit DIP + 6-pin header	DIP and header in parallel on PC0-PC5
CAD	EasyEDA Pro	KiCad 6-format project zip for import

Deliverables (Rev D): an importable project zip (9-sheet wired schematic + fully routed 160 x 105 mm 4-layer PCB), Gerbers / drill / CPL for JLCPCB, schematic and layer PDFs, BOMs, and pin-map.xlsx. The netlist was checked pin by pin against the design: 124 nets, 237 parts, 0 mismatches. A second check confirmed that only T1, U12 and the optional Y-cap connect primary nets to secondary nets.

Rev D changes: NTC moved from PA4 to PA6, so PA4 is free for DAC1_OUT1. 10k pull-downs added on the unused MCU pins (R93 now doubles as the PA2 pull-down for the VIN monitor). HSE changed to 16 MHz. Primary input OVP (50.26 V rising) reports through U12 channel 1 to PA15 / HRTIM1_FLT2, and an isolated VIN monitor (ramp-comparator PWM) reports through channel 2 to PA2 / TIM15_CH1. The ADC, DAC and comparator reference is now an external REF3030 (3.000 V ±0.2 %) on VREF+, no longer the isolator's 3.3 V rail. Fifteen test pads added on quiet nodes. PQ2620 footprint pitch corrected to 3.8 mm within a group of pins and 7.5 mm between pins 3 and 4. Schematic text overlaps cleaned up. The PCB was re-placed and re-routed with tight power loops, and the silkscreen was cleaned up (see PCB).

Topology: LLC DCX + secondary 4SBB

An LLC alone cannot regulate this range. Frequency control gives roughly 0.7-1.5x gain, but 12-48 V in to 1.5-48 V out needs about 128:1. So the LLC runs at its resonant frequency as a fixed-ratio isolation stage (DCX), and the 4SBB does all the regulation on the secondary.

1. Primary: VIN -> half-bridge (Q5/Q6, NCEP0160AG) -> split resonant capacitors (2 x 300 nF C0G) -> PQ2620 primary. Lr is the transformer leakage, 1.0 uH.
2. Barrier: T1 (Np 4 : Ns 8+8) and U12 (CA-IS3642LVW). U12 carries the LLC gate signals to the primary and powers the secondary MCU at 3.3 V from the primary.
3. Secondary: centre-tapped synchronous rectifier (Q7/Q8, BSC160N15NS5, 150 V) -> isolated bus VBUS about equal to VIN (12-48 V) -> the 4SBB from the earlier design, unchanged.

Running at resonance gives ZVS on the primary and near-zero-current switching on the SRs at every input voltage, so the LLC is very efficient except at 12 V in, where its currents peak.

Start-up sequence:

1. VIN rises and the primary aux (U13 + U14) makes 10 V and 5 V. U12 then powers the MCU, which boots.
2. The MCU starts the LLC with a duty and frequency soft-start: about 2.5 x fr and small duty, ramping to fr and 50% over about 10 ms. The SRs stay off, so the body diodes rectify.
3. VBUS rises and the secondary aux (U4) makes 10 V, then U5 makes 5 V for CAN.
4. The MCU enables the SRs (SR_EN), then starts the 4SBB.

LLC sizing

The LLC runs at about 205 kHz with Cr = 600 nF, Lr = 1.0 uH (leakage) and Lm = 50 uH. ZVS needs Lm at or below 94 uH with 150 ns dead time, so 50 uH has about 1.9x margin at every input voltage. Peak flux is 63 mT at 48 V in, so core loss stays at or below 0.2 W.

VIN	Bus power	Primary rms	SR rms (each)	LLC loss	LLC efficiency	4SBB loss	Total loss	Total efficiency
12 V	53.6 W	10.1 A	3.6 A	3.9 W	93.2%	3.6 W	7.5 W	86.9%
18 V	53.1 W	6.7 A	2.4 A	2.0 W	96.3%	3.1 W	5.2 W	90.7%
24 V	53.2 W	5.0 A	1.8 A	1.4 W	97.4%	3.2 W	4.6 W	91.5%
36 V	53.4 W	3.4 A	1.2 A	1.0 W	98.1%	3.4 W	4.5 W	91.8%
48 V	53.7 W	2.6 A	0.9 A	1.0 W	98.1%	3.7 W	4.7 W	91.4%

Each row uses the 4SBB operating point that draws the most bus power at that input. SR drain voltage reaches 95 V at 48 V in (2 x VBUS), which is why the SRs are 150 V parts. Resonant capacitor voltage peaks at 28 V, inside the 100 V C0G rating. At 12 V in the primary FETs dissipate 0.6 W each and the transformer about 1.1 W, so give the primary side the same copper and via treatment as the 4SBB.

Transformer specification (custom, for a winding house): PQ2620 core in N97/PC95 or equivalent. Primary 4 turns rated for 10 A rms: 0.15 x 8 mm copper foil (litz 0.1 x 200 does not fit the 3.3 mm radial build of the vendor bobbin together with the secondary; litz 0.1 x 100 just fits). Secondary 8 + 8 turns centre-tapped in triple-insulated wire, 3.6 A rms per half. Lm 50 uH +/-10% (gapped), leakage 1.0 uH +/-20%, hipot 3 kVrms primary-secondary for 60 s. Leakage tolerance moves fr by about +/-10%, so firmware should trim the switching frequency to the measured VBUS/VIN ratio or to minimum primary current.

4SBB regulator sizing (secondary, input = VBUS)

The power stage runs at 150 kHz with L = 22 uH. Peak inductor current is 6.2 A and RMS is 5.05 A, both at 48 V in / 10 V / 5 A. Going from 200 kHz / 15 uH to 150 kHz / 22 uH cut the hottest FET loss from 1.69 W to 1.38 W.

FET choice follows what each switch does. Q1 and Q4 hard-switch, so they use the low-Qgd NCEP0140AG (100 V, 23 mOhm max, Qgd 3.8 nC). Q2 and Q3 carry the full 5 A in buck mode as synchronous rectifier and static-on switch, so they use the low-Rds NCEP0160AG (100 V, 8.5 mOhm max).

Operating point	Mode	Efficiency	Total loss	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Inductor
12 V -> 5 V, 5 A	buck	89.5%	2.93 W	0.57 W	0.21 W	0.30 W	-	0.69 W

Operating point	Mode	Efficiency	Total loss	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Inductor
12 V -> 12 V, 4.2 A	transition	93.5%	3.46 W	0.88 W	0.08 W	0.28 W	0.34 W	0.66 W
12 V -> 48 V, 1.04 A	boost	93.3%	3.62 W	0.60 W	-	0.09 W	1.38 W	0.62 W
24 V -> 24 V, 2.1 A	transition	95.5%	2.37 W	0.55 W	0.03 W	0.08 W	0.41 W	0.22 W
48 V -> 1.5 V, 5 A	buck	68.2%	3.50 W	0.99 W	0.33 W	0.30 W	-	0.68 W
48 V -> 10 V, 5 A	buck	93.2%	3.67 W	1.14 W	0.28 W	0.30 W	-	0.76 W
48 V -> 48 V, 1.04 A	transition	94.7%	2.79 W	0.80 W	0.01 W	0.03 W	0.76 W	0.16 W

Total loss includes 0.7 W housekeeping (MCU, CAN, aux supplies), which is why 1.5 V / 7.5 W shows 68%. Model assumptions: Rds at 1.4x the 25 C max, 8 ns V-I overlap per hard edge, 30 ns dead time, Qrr 50-80 nC (not listed for NCEP0160AG, so assumed), inductor DCR 25 mOhm.

Thermal: with 1.4 W in a DFN5x6 on 2 oz copper with a via array to inner planes (about 35-40 C/W), junction rise is about 50-55 C, so Tj is about 85 C at 30 C ambient. Minimum buck on-time is 234 ns at 48 V -> 1.5 V, well above the HRTIM's 184 ps resolution and the UCC27211's propagation delay.

Inductor: PSPMAA1770-220M-CGP, 22 uH, Isat 23 A, Irms 12 A, DCR 25 mOhm, 17 x 17 mm. Bourns SRP1770TA-220M is a drop-in alternate on the same footprint.

Control, sensing and MCU pin map

HRTIM Timer A drives the input leg and Timer E drives the output leg, both synchronised to the master timer. Each timer outputs a complementary pair with hardware dead time into one UCC27211. PA11/PA12 are kept for FDCAN1, which is why Timer B is not used. Timer C runs the LLC through the isolator, and Timer D runs the SRs, phase-locked to Timer C with about 30 ns lead to cover isolator and driver delay. In the 4SBB table below, VIN means VBUS, which tracks VIN within about 2%.

Inductor current is sensed by one 4 mOhm resistor in the common source return of Q2 and Q4 (the LM5175 scheme). It reads positive in boost and negative in buck, so U7 (INA181A1, gain 20) is offset to half of VREF+ (1.50 V). Output current for the CC loop uses a 10 mOhm low-side shunt and U8 (INA181A2, gain 50). VREF+ is driven by an external REF3030 (3.000 V ±0.2 %, U19) with 1 uF + 100 nF, so all ADC, DAC and comparator full scales are 3.0 V; the U7 offset is 1.50 V.

Pin	Port	Function	Net
42 / 43	PA8 / PA9	HRTIM1_CHA1 / CHA2 -> Q1 / Q2	PWM_A1 / PWM_A2

Pin	Port	Function	Net
40 / 41	PC8 / PC9	HRTIM1_CHE1 / CHE2 -> Q3 / Q4	PWM_E1 / PWM_E2
45 / 46	PA11 / PA12	FDCAN1_RX / TX	CAN_RXD / CAN_TXD
12	PA0	ADC1_IN1, VBUS about equal to VIN (100k / 5.1k, FS 61.8 V)	VBUS_SNS
33	PB11	ADC1_IN14 + COMP6_INP, VOUT + fast OVP	VOUT_SNS
13	PA1	ADC1_IN2, output current, 0.5 V/A	IOUT_SNS
25	PB1	ADC1_IN12 + COMP1_INP, positive OCP (boost)	IL_SNS
24	PB0	COMP4_INP, negative OCP (buck), polarity inverted	IL_SNS
8-11, 22, 23	PC0-PC5	Address bits 0-5	ADDR0-ADDR5
49 / 50 / 56	PA13 / PA14 / PB3	SWDIO / SWCLK / SWO	J6
19 / 59 / 60	PA5 / PB6 / PB7	DAC1_OUT2 test output / test GPIO 1 / test GPIO 2 (J6 pads 3-5)	TP_DAC / TP_GPIO1 / TP_GPIO2
62 / 52	PB9 / PC10	RUN / FAULT LEDs, active low	LED_RUN / LED_FLT
34 / 35	PB12 / PB13	HRTIM1_CHC1 / CHC2 -> U12 -> U10 -> Q5 / Q6 (LLC)	LLC_A / LLC_B
36 / 37	PB14 / PB15	HRTIM1_CHD1 / CHD2 -> U11 -> Q7 / Q8 (SR)	SR1_PWM / SR2_PWM
53	PC11	SR driver enable, active high	SR_EN
20	PA6	ADC2_IN3, NTC beside Q2 / RS1 (Rev D: moved off PA4)	NTC_SNS

Pin	Port	Function	Net
5 / 6	PF0 / PF1	16 MHz HSE (Rev D), PLL M4 N85 R2 -> 170 MHz	OSC_IN / OSC_OUT
51	PA15	HRTIM1_FLT2 (AF13), input OVP, active high (Rev D)	VIN_OVP
28	VREF+	ADC / DAC / COMP reference input from REF3030 3.000 V (U19); VREFBUF disabled	VREF_ADC
14	PA2	TIM15_CH1 (AF9), PWM input: isolated VIN monitor, 10k pull-down R93 (Rev D)	VIN_PWM
18	PA4	Reserved for DAC1_OUT1, 10k pull-down	SP_PA4
2-4, 17, 21, 26, 30, 38, 39, 44, 54, 55, 57, 58	PC13-15, PA3, PA7, PB2, PB10, PC6, PC7, PA10, PC12, PD2, PB4, PB5	Unused: 10k to GND each (R90-R105, except R93, which is now the pull-down for PA2 = VIN_PWM, TIM15_CH1)	SP_<port>

Every pin, with all alternate functions (AF0-AF15) copied from ST's pin database and a column for what this design uses, is in **pin-map.xlsx** (01_hardware/docs).

Comparator thresholds come from DAC3, and COMP1/4/6 outputs feed HRTIM fault inputs internally for cycle-by-cycle shutdown with no external parts. The INA181 bandwidth (350 kHz) is fine for averaged control and OCP but too slow for true peak-current-mode control, so plan on voltage-mode or average-current-mode loops.

Firmware must handle these board-specific items:

- Bootstrap refresh: Q1 is static-on in boost and Q3 in buck. Cap their duty at about 98% or insert a short low-side pulse every few cycles so the bootstrap capacitors stay charged.
- Output voltage correction: the VOUT divider is referenced to board GND, so VOUT = V_divider + IOUT x 10 mOhm (up to 50 mV at 5 A).
- Current-sense zero: U7's REF is a 1k / 1k divider from VREF, which leaves a small gain and offset error. Measure IL_SNS with all FETs off at start-up and subtract it.

- ADC reference: VREF+ is driven by U19 (REF3030, 3.000 V). Leave the internal VREFBUF disabled, as it is after reset (VREFBUF_CSR: ENVR = 0, HIZ = 1); enabling it would fight U19. Scale every ADC, DAC3 and comparator value to 3.0 V full scale. VREFINT is no longer needed for correction, but it makes a useful sanity check on VREF+.
- VIN monitor: TIM15 in PWM-input mode on PA2, VIN = 50.47 V × (t_high − t_reset) / (period − t_reset) − 0.20 V, t_reset about 20 µs, average 8–16 periods, two-point calibration stored in flash.
- Input OVP: configure HRTIM1_FLT2 on PA15 active-high so VIN_OVP shuts all HRTIM outputs in hardware.

Full-scale and threshold summary

Every ADC channel, DAC3 and the comparators use VREF+ = VREF_ADC = 3.000 V from an external REF3030AIDBZR (U19, LCSC C38423). It is ±0.2 % initial, with drift of 50 ppm/°C max (0–70 °C) and 75 ppm/°C max (−40 to 125 °C). U19 runs from +3V3A, and its 50 mV max dropout fits inside the isolator's 3.13 V minimum output. It sources up to 25 mA, so it drives VREF+ (1 µF + 100 nF, C36/C37), the IL zero divider and the NTC pull-up directly, with no buffer. Firmware must keep the internal VREFBUF off (VREFBUF_CSR: ENVR = 0, HIZ = 1). The IL zero (R25/R26) and the NTC pull-up (R29) now hang on VREF_ADC, so those two channels are ratiometric. VDDA (+3V3A) only powers the analog blocks.

Signal	MCU input	Conversion	Full scale	1 LSB	Normal use
VBUS (about VIN)	PA0, ADC1_IN1	100k / 5.1k, 0.1 %: ÷20.61	0–61.8 V	15.1 mV	12–48 V = 19–78 % of FS
VOUT	PB11, ADC1_IN14 + COMP6	100k / 5.1k, 0.1 %: ÷20.61	0–61.8 V	15.1 mV	1.5–48 V; add IOUT × 10 mΩ
Inductor current IL	PB1 ADC1_IN12 + COMP1; PB0 COMP4	4 mΩ × 20 = 80 mV/A, zero at VREF/2 = 1.50 V	±18.75 A (about ±18 A usable, INA181 output swing)	9.2 mA	peak 6.2 A = 33 % of FS
Output current IOUT	PA1, ADC1_IN2	10 mΩ × 50 = 0.5 V/A	0–6.0 A	1.5 mA	5 A = 2.5 V (83 % of FS)
Temperature NTC	PA6, ADC2_IN3	10k pull-up from VREF_ADC, 10k B3950 to GND	−40 °C (2.93 V) to 125 °C (0.10 V)	0.02 °C at 25 °C, 0.14 °C at 100 °C	25 °C = 1.50 V, 100 °C = 0.195 V
VIN (isolated monitor)	PA2, TIM15_CH1	VIN = 50.47 V × x − 0.20 V (see VIN monitor)	0–50.5 V; readable 9.7–50.3 V	about 1 mV (51,700 counts)	12–48 V

Signal	MCU input	Conversion	Full scale	1 LSB	Normal use
VIN over-voltage	PA15, HRTIM1_FLT2	Primary comparator, digital	Trips at 50.26 V rising, clears at 49.83 V (±1.3 %)	—	Below the 51 V TVS stand-off
Fast fault thresholds	DAC3 into COMP1 / 4 / 6	12-bit, 0–3.0 V	IL ±18.75 A, VOUT 0–61.8 V	9.2 mA, 15.1 mV	Set per mode by firmware

Error budget, untrimmed: VBUS and VOUT about ±0.3 % (REF3030 ±0.2 %, 0.1 % dividers, ADC), plus up to about ±0.35 % from reference drift over 0–70 °C. IL and IOUT are about ±1.5 % (INA181 gain ±1 %, 1 % shunts) plus offset, so zero both at start-up with the power stage off. A one-point calibration of VBUS/VOUT at room temperature leaves only the drift term. VIN is about ±1.5 %, or about ±0.5 % after a two-point calibration (separate TL431 reference on the primary side).

Input over-voltage protection (Rev D)

A comparator on the primary side watches VIN and reports through the spare forward channel of the isolator U12 (VI1 -> VO1), so no extra barrier part is needed.

Part	Value	Job
R81 / R82	191k (1206) / 10k, 0.1 %	VIN divider, 1 nF C0G filter (C79)
U16	TL431AIDBZR	2.495 V reference, ±1 % (A grade; TL431BIDBZR is a 0.5 % drop-in), 1k bias from +5V_P (R85)
U15	LMV331IDBVR	Open-drain comparator, + = divider, - = reference
R83 / R84	10k / 2.2M	Pull-up to +5V_P / hysteresis

Trip point = 50.26 V rising and 49.83 V falling (0.43 V hysteresis). This is 2.495 V × (1 + 191k / (10k ‖ 2.2M)), less about 0.2 V from the VIN-monitor feedback R110. Tolerance is about ±1.3 % (TL431A ±1 %, comparator offset), so 49.6–50.9 V, still below the 51 V TVS stand-off. Above it OVP_P goes high, U12 VO1 drives VIN_OVP high and PA15 (HRTIM1_FLT2, active high) shuts every HRTIM output in hardware. The 51 V TVS still clamps fast transients; the comparator stops switching for sustained over-voltage.

Test points (Rev D) are 1.5 mm pads on quiet nodes only: rails VIN, +10V_P, +5V_P, VBUS, +10V, +5V, +3V3, +3V3A, VOUT, the grounds GNDP / GND, and the filtered IL_SNS, IOUT_SNS and VIN_OVP. No test pad sits on a switch node, gate or high-impedance divider, so they add no antenna. TP1-TP4 are primary-side and float relative to earth.

Input voltage monitor (PWM over isolation)

VIN is read for monitoring only, not for control. The reading crosses the isolation barrier on the spare isolator channel, so the circuit needs no isolated amplifier. It reuses the OVP divider (R81/R82, now 0.1 %) and the TL431 reference (U16) that are already on the primary side.

Block	Parts	What it does
Ramp	Q9 MMBT3906, R86 56k, R87 10k, R88 15k, C82 47 nF C0G	PNP current source (~24 µA) charges C82 linearly from 0 to VREF_P in about 5 ms (~200 Hz)
Reset	U17 LMV331, R106 1k, D7 1N4148W, C81 220 pF C0G, R107 100k, Q10 2N7002, R89 22 Ω	When RAMP passes VREF_P, U17 releases and charges C81 through D7 in about 0.2 µs. R107 then holds Q10 on for about 15–30 µs, which empties C82 to under 1 mV
PWM comparator	U18 LMV331, R109 1k, R110 4.7M, R108 10k	IN+ = OVP_DIV, IN− = RAMP (through R109). VINPWM_P is high while RAMP < OVP_DIV, and during the reset. R110 feeds about 10 mV of hysteresis back into the low-impedance divider, never into the ramp
Isolation	U12 channel 2 (pin 4 → pin 13)	VINPWM_P on the primary side becomes VIN_PWM on the secondary side
MCU	PA2 (pin 14), R93 10k pull-down	TIM15_CH1 in PWM-input mode measures the period and the high time

Firmware formula. Run TIM15 in PWM-input mode on PA2 (prescaler 16, giving about 51,700 counts per 4.9 ms period). With x = (t_high − t_reset) / (period − t_reset) and t_reset about 20 µs: VIN = 50.47 V × x − 0.20 V. The 50.47 V includes R84 (OVP_P low in normal running) and R110; the −0.20 V is the R110 feedback. Full scale is 50.5 V, and readings are valid from about 9.7 V (primary aux start) up to the OVP trip. Average 8–16 periods (one reading every 40–80 ms).

Accuracy. A behavioural simulation of the final circuit gives the formula within 0.02 % from 12 to 48 V, so the ramp is linear. Untrimmed, expect about ±1.5 %: TL431A ±1 %, comparator offsets up to ±7 mV, and the spread of t_reset (15–30 µs, from the 2N7002

threshold). Use a **two-point calibration** (for example 24 V and 48 V, gain and offset stored in flash), because the t_reset spread acts as an offset. After calibration expect about ±0.5 % over temperature, limited by TL431 drift. Isolator delay skew (a few ns) is negligible against a 5 ms period.

Review fix (18 Oct). The first version took the U18 hysteresis from the comparator output back onto the ramp (R109 10k / R110 1M). That 1 MΩ path drew up to 10 % of the 24 µA ramp current and reversed direction when U18 switched. The ramp bent, and simulation showed reading errors of +12.5 % at 12 V and +1.5 % at 48 V, with 3.6 % left even after a two-point calibration. The hysteresis now goes into the divider: U18 inputs swapped, R110 4.7 M to OVP_DIV, R109 1k. The reset pulse was also hardened: C81 1 nF → 220 pF and R107 22k → 100k. The gate now charges fully before U17 lets go, so C82 always discharges to near 0 V.

On the PCB, the block sits on the primary side below U15/U16 (x 40–64 mm, y 85–97 mm). VIN_PWM leaves U12 pin 13 through a via and runs on inner and bottom layers to R93/PA2. Clearance from primary copper to secondary copper is unchanged.

Auxiliary supplies, isolated CAN, addressing

There are now two auxiliary chains, one on each side of the barrier.

Side	Chain	Feeds
Primary (GNDP)	VIN -> U13 LMR16006X -> 10 V_P -> U14 AMS1117-5.0 -> 5 V_P	U10 LLC driver; U12 isolator (about 0.6 W in)
Barrier	U12 CA-IS3642LVW isolated output, SEL = GNDB	+3V3 for the MCU, sensing, LEDs and CAN VCCL (75 mA budget, 130 mA max)
Secondary (GND)	VBUS -> U4 LMR16006X -> 10 V -> U5 AMS1117-5.0 -> 5 V	U2/U3 4SBB drivers, U11 SR driver, CAN VCC

The MCU is powered whenever VIN is present. The 10 V and 5 V secondary rails, and so CAN, come up only once the LLC is running, which is why the MCU starts the LLC automatically at power-up. Both bucks start at about 9.7 V through their EN dividers (470k / 68k) and regulate to 9.95 V (120k / 10k).

CAN uses the CA-IS3062VW, which has its own isolated DC-DC, so no separate isolated module is needed. VCC is 5 V and VCCL is 3.3 V, so TXD/RXD connect directly to the MCU. The bus side has split termination (2 x 60.4 Ohm + 4.7 nF) enabled by JP1, a 2x2 header that breaks both legs (pins 1-2 CANH to R30, pins 3-4 R31 to CANL; fit both shunts on an end-of-bus node). With no shunts the termination is fully off both lines, so CANH no

longer sees the 60 Ohm + 4.7 nF load that the earlier single-jumper layout left on it, an NUP2105L TVS, and two 3-pin connectors for daisy-chaining. A 2.2 nF / 2 kV Y-cap across the barrier is placed but marked DNP.

Address bits are read on PC0-PC5 with 10k pull-ups. DIP switch ON pulls a bit to 0. Header J5 is wired in parallel through 1k series resistors, so a harness that grounds a pin also sets that bit to 0.

The 6-pin header has no ground pin of its own. It relies on the harness sharing ground through the power connector. If the harness is not ground-referenced, J5 needs a 7th pin.

Connectors, programming and mounting

Ref	Function	Part	Pins
J1	Input 12-48 V (primary)	KF2EDGR-5.08-2P pluggable male header, 5.08 mm, 12 A	1 VIN, 2 GNDP
J2	Output 1.5-48 V	KF2EDGR-5.08-2P pluggable male header, 5.08 mm, 12 A	1 VOUT, 2 VOUT- (after the 10 mOhm shunt)
J3, J4	CAN in / out (daisy chain)	2.54 mm 1x3 male pin header	1 CANH, 2 CANL, 3 GND_ISO
J6	Programming pads (pogo fixture)	8 round SMD pads, 2.0 mm, 2.54 mm pitch, pad 1 square	1 SWDIO, 2 SWCLK, 3 Test_pin_DAC (PA5), 4 Test_pin_GPIO1 (PB6), 5 Test_pin_GPIO2 (PB7), 6 NRST, 7 VCC_3.3, 8 GND
J7	ARM Cortex Debug 10-pin	2x5 1.27 mm SMD header (FTSH-105 or equivalent)	1 VTref 3.3 V, 2 SWDIO, 3/5/9 GND, 4 SWCLK, 6 SWO, 7 key, 8 NC, 10 nRESET
H1-H4	M3 standoffs	3.2 mm non-plated holes, 4 mm from each corner	-

The old 8-pin SWD/UART header is gone, so USART2 (PA2/PA3) is no longer brought out; PA3 is free, and PA2 now reads the VIN monitor PWM (TIM15_CH1).

The schematic is now 9 sheets: a top sheet plus one A3 sheet per block (LLC stage, primary aux and isolator, 4SBB power and drivers, secondary aux, MCU, sensing, CAN, IO). Parts inside a sheet are joined by wires, rails use power symbols, and only signals that go to another sheet carry a global label.

BOM and sourcing

The estimated BOM is about $36.85 per board at 100 pcs: 227 placed parts on 90 lines, excluding PCB and assembly. The isolation stage (LLC, isolator, primary aux, OVP and VIN monitor) adds about $13.02, which is 54% over the $23.92 non-isolated design (which now includes the $0.50 REF3030 ADC reference). That misses the 20% premium target.

Isolation-stage part	Qty	Cost @100
CA-IS3642LVW isolator + isolated 3.3 V (C7422564)	1	$2.51
PQ2620 transformer, custom wound (estimate)	1	about $2.50
UCC27211DDAR primary driver (C141980)	1	$1.61
BSC160N15NS5 SR FET (C459172)	2	$1.50
NCEP0160AG primary FET (C503012)	2	$1.47
2.2 uF 100 V X7R 1210	4	$1.45
100 nF 100 V C0G 1206, resonant caps (estimate)	6	$0.48
LMR16006X + AMS1117-5.0 + passives, primary aux	-	about $0.80
UCC27524DR SR driver (C465729)	1	$0.21

The nearest realistic cost-downs are about $2.30, which would bring the premium to about 45%:

- Generic 100 V X7R 1210 capacitors instead of the Samsung part (about -$1.00).
- A lower-cost half-bridge driver in place of UCC27211 on the primary (about -$1.30).

Getting to 20% would take a different isolation approach, for example a lower-power isolated stage or a cheaper digital isolator plus a discrete isolated supply. The 20% target may have been set against a different baseline, so it's worth confirming which one applies.

The remaining key parts, below, are unchanged from the non-isolated design.

Part	LCSC	Price @100	Stock (2026-10-17)
STM32G474RBT6	C529413	$7.24	Out of stock. Fallback: pin-compatible STM32G474RET6 C521608, $10.24, 12 pcs
CA-IS3062VW	C5338808	$2.51	5,206

Part	LCSC	Price @100	Stock (2026-10-17)
UCC27211DDAR x2	C141980	$1.61	500. Second source SLM27211CA-DG C967931 is out of stock
PSPMAA1770-220M-CGP	C49308184	about $1.00	120 (low). Alternate: Bourns SRP1770TA-220M
NCEP0160AG x2	C503012	$0.74	3,585
NCEP0140AG x2	C503009	about $0.40	1,492
CL32B225KCJSNNE 2.2 uF 100 V 1210 x9	C55151	$0.36	Out of stock; any 100 V X7R 1210 works
LMR16006XDDCR	C87080	$0.36	50,921
INA181A1IDBVR / INA181A2IDBVR	C2058943 / C2058784	$0.24 each	1,290 / 20,420
REF3030AIDBZR (ADC reference)	C38423	about $0.50 (estimate)	Not checked; confirm before ordering

Generic passives (resistors, small MLCCs) carry value, voltage, dielectric and package in the BOM but no LCSC number. Let EasyEDA Pro's BOM tool match them to JLCPCB basic parts.

PCB (Rev D) and layout review

The board is 160 x 105 mm, 4 layers, with 257 footprints, 1,882 track segments and 761 vias (after the 18 Oct clean-up, the VIN monitor and the REF3030 ADC reference). It is fully routed and KiCad DRC reports 0 errors, 0 unconnected pads and 0 silkscreen warnings. The only other DRC lines are 199 "footprint differs from library" notices. They appear because the standard KiCad libraries are not installed where the check ran, and they do not affect the board.

Layer	Use
Top	Parts. Hot-loop copper is pre-routed at 1.0-2.5 mm and locked, with local power pours around each loop and a ground flood per domain
Inner 1	Solid split planes GNDP / GND / GND_ISO directly under every power loop

Layer	Use
Inner 2	Signals, ground flood in the free space
Bottom	Signals, VBUS bar from the T1 centre tap to the 4SBB, VOUT_N bar, ground flood

Power path

- **LLC primary.** C61-C63 straddle the Q5 drain and the Q6 source, so the half-bridge loop is about 9 x 8 mm over the GNDP plane. The HB_SW node is a small pour going straight into T1 pins 1-3. CR1-CR6 sit in one column against the T1 CR_MID pins.
- **Input.** J1 -> F1 -> D1 / C60 -> the C61-C63 bank on 2.5 mm copper plus a VIN pour.
- **Synchronous rectifier.** The Q7/Q8 drains face the T1 SR pins (about 4 mm). The VBUS ceramics C2-C4 sit between the T1 centre tap and the SR sources.
- **VBUS to the 4SBB.** A 2.5 mm bottom-layer bar plus four 0.8 mm vias runs from the T1 centre tap to C5/C6/Q1.
- **4SBB.** It follows the LM5175 layout: L1 on top, Q1/Q2 on the left, Q3/Q4 on the right. The low-side sources face each other, joined by a PGND bar into RS1. The input ceramics are at the Q1 drain and the output ceramics at the Q3 drain. The ground returns run on Inner 1 directly under each loop.
- **Output.** Q3 -> C7-C12 -> C11 -> J2 on 1.5-2.5 mm copper plus a VOUT pour. VOUT_N runs from J2 to RSH1 on a bottom-layer bar.

Noise and interference

- Switch nodes (HB_SW, SW1, SW2, SR_D1, SR_D2) are kept to small pours. They carry no test pads, and the Inner 1 ground shields every Inner 2 or bottom signal crossing under them.
- Kelvin sensing: U7 taps the inner edges of the RS1 pads and U8 taps RSH1. Neither amplifier input gets a plane via. The NTC now sits between Q2 and RS1, the hottest spot.
- MCU: U1 is rotated so that its HRTIM and sense pins face the power stage. A GND island under the LQFP with 16 vias to Inner 1 serves as the return for all VSS pins and decoupling. Every unused pin has its own 10k pull-down, fanned out so escape routes stay free.
- Isolation: 4 mm no-copper bands on all layers. Only T1, U12 and C66 bridge primary to secondary, and only U9 and C56 bridge to the CAN side.

Review before ordering

- **Gate-drive loops are longer than ideal.** Measured from driver pin to FET gate they run 14-42 mm: U2 -> Q1 is 42 mm, U3 -> Q3 31 mm, U11 -> Q8 30 mm, and U10 -> Q5/Q6 24-26 mm. Pulling U2, U3 and U11 closer to their FETs, with each gate resistor next to its gate pin, would cut ringing and EMI. This is the first thing I would hand-tune in EasyEDA.
- The crystal traces are 10-11 mm with two vias each. Keep them on the top layer next to Y1 if you touch that area.
- The long HRTIM, ADC and CAN lines (30-75 mm) run on Inner 2 / bottom over the ground plane. That is fine for these edge rates, but do not route them under L1 or the switch nodes when editing.
- T1 footprint takes either vendor bobbin: PQ2620 6+6 (25.4 mm rows, 0.70 mm pins, 29 x 27 mm base, 20.8 mm high) or PQ2625 6+6 (25.5 mm rows, 0.80 mm pins, 29.8 x 26.7 mm base, 25.3 mm high). Same 3.8 / 7.5 mm pin pattern; 1.2 mm holes; outline sized for the PQ2625. CR1-CR6 moved 0.7 mm left, Q7/Q8 0.68 mm right, T1 0.1 mm right to clear it.
- Silkscreen: references are 0.8 mm and moved clear of pads and other silk. C2–C4 (VBUS ceramics at the SR) and C67 (HBP bootstrap) are too crowded for a reference, so theirs are hidden and shown only on the assembly (Fab) layer.
- Optional: a milled slot in the primary/secondary band, between T1 and U12, if your standard needs more creepage.
- ADC reference: on the first board, check VREF+ with a scope while the ADC is converting. The REF30 datasheet asks for care with large low-ESR ceramics on its output; if VREF+ rings, put 1–2 Ω in series with C36.
- Confirm the CA-IS3642 3.3 V output stays at or above about 3.08 V at full load and temperature, which is the REF3030's 3.000 V plus its 50 mV maximum dropout plus the FB1 drop. The minimum you quoted, about 3.13 V, leaves roughly 80 mV of margin.

Layout review and clean-up (18 Oct)

A full pass over noise, interference and loss. The table lists what was found and changed on the board; checks afterwards: DRC 0 errors, netlist parity 237 parts / 125 nets, primary-secondary and secondary-CAN copper gaps still 4.0 mm on every layer.

Finding	Effect	Change	Result
Output path C11 to J2 was one 1.0 mm track, 21 mm long	about 10 mOhm, 0.25 W and 50 mV drop at 5 A	VOUT pour along the path	about 3.5 mOhm, 0.09 W

Finding	Effect	Change	Result
CR1-CR6 only touched the pours at their pad edges after the PQ2625 move	10 A rms primary current through 1.0 mm tracks	VIN and GNDP pours over the left pads, CR_MID pour extended over the right pads	full-width connection on both sides
4SBB switch-node copper SW1/SW2 larger than needed	radiates and couples to chassis/heat sink	SW1/SW2 pours cut to L1 pad, FET pins/tab and the path between; driver-return traces on In2 narrowed	SW1 282 to 213 mm2, SW2 271 to 211 mm2
Q1 high-side gate loop: return trace far from the gate trace	ringing, slower and noisier switching	SW1 driver return re-routed on In2 0.8 mm beside G1	loop about 85 to about 15 mm2
Q3 high-side gate loop; G3 was 0.25 mm on B.Cu	same	G3 0.5 mm; SW2 return on B.Cu parallel to it from a via at the Q3 source pins	loop about 47 to about 18 mm2
Q5 (LLC high side) gate loop	same, smaller	HB_SW return on B.Cu right beside the G5 run	loop about 17 to about 8 mm2
U8 sense lines tapped the GND pour and a load-carrying track instead of the RSH1 pads	small output-current error	both taps moved inside the RSH1 pads (true Kelvin)	U7 was already Kelvin
Router staircases (1400 segments under 0.45 mm)	extra corners, hard to edit	replaced by straight or 45-degree runs, clearance-checked	2906 to 1810 segments
Ground floods only loosely tied to the In1 planes	floods resonate, weaker return paths	320 stitching vias on a 5 mm grid where a ground net is poured on all four layers (GND 110, GNDP 194, GND_ISO 16)	427 to 747 vias in total

Left as is, with the reason:

- In1 planes are continuous: the longest antipad gap is 3.8 mm, a row of VBUS vias away from any return path.
- The SR loop (T1 secondary, Q7/Q8, C2-C4) and the LLC half-bridge loop are already compact.
- LLC gate drive to Q6 returns through the GNDP plane directly under it.

Recommended for Rev E (needs placement changes):

- Move U2 and U3 next to Q1/Q2 and Q3/Q4. They sit about 20 mm away; the pairing above limits the loop area but not the inductance of the length.
- The boost-mode hot loop runs from C7-C10 (x 143-153) back to RS1 (x 122). Move two of the 2.2 uF output MLCCs next to Q3/Q4, or add a 100 nF MLCC from VOUT to PGND right at Q4, so the high-frequency loop closes at the FETs.

Importing into EasyEDA Pro, and layout

Import the zip from the EasyEDA Pro start page, or through its Format Converter. EasyEDA's documentation lists KiCad 5.1 as supported and is unclear about newer versions, so the schematic is written in KiCad 6 format, the most widely accepted. The PCB file is KiCad 7 format because that is what the generator writes. (EasyEDA import docs, format converter)

1. Import DCDC_LLC_4SBB_G474_EasyEDA_import.zip. It carries its own library for the PQ2620 transformer and the programming pads (custom_fp).
2. If the PCB is rejected, import the schematic alone. Every part carries LCSC and MPN fields, so you can swap in EasyEDA library parts, which bring their own footprints.
3. Check the result against the schematic and PCB PDFs. The schematic is 9 wired sheets. The PCB is the routed Rev D board (see PCB).

To open the project in KiCad instead, install KiCad 7 or newer with its standard libraries (the default Windows installer includes them). The project's own sym-lib-table and fp-lib-table add the custom libraries. With the standard libraries present, DRC also stops reporting "footprint differs from library".

Open questions

- [ ] Is 48 V the absolute maximum input, or are there transients above it? The 51 V TVS and 63 V electrolytics assume 48 V maximum.
- [ ] Is reverse-polarity protection needed beyond fuse + TVS? An ideal-diode FET would add about $0.5 and 0.1-0.2 W.

- [ ] Does the address harness share ground with the power input? If not, J5 needs a ground pin.
- [ ] Which baseline does the 20% two-stage premium refer to? Against the non-isolated design the LLC stage adds about 55%.
- [ ] Which safety standard and pollution degree apply? That sets the final creepage and transformer construction for basic insulation.
- [ ] Is 87% efficiency and 7.5 W loss at 12 V in acceptable for passive cooling? If not, the primary could become a full bridge, roughly halving the primary conduction loss for about $2 more.
- [x] ~~PQ2620 bobbin row-to-row spacing: 25.4 mm from the vendor drawing (footprint updated).~~
- [ ] Footprints to confirm against the parts you buy: NCEP01x0AG DFN5x6 (placed as Infineon TDSON-8-1), the 22 uH / 23 A inductor (Bourns SRP1770), KF2EDGR-5.08 (Phoenix MSTBA 5.08), the UCC27211DDAR exposed pad, the SW1 DIP-6 part number, the 7 A / 63 V 2512 fuse, and the 1 A rating of the 47 uH SRP5030 inductors.

Sources: component data from the LCSC/JLCPCB listings and datasheets linked above, and the CA-IS3062 datasheet, UCC27211 datasheet and INA181 datasheet. STM32G474 pin functions are from the STM32CubeMX pin database.